

Example 1. Twelve-bar ballad meter, with ABR poetic form and 7,7,5 phrase rhythm. (a) Mississippi John Hurt, “Frankie” (1928), sixth verse; (b) Will Bennett, “Railroad Bill” (1929), third verse; (c) Charlie Poole with the North Carolina Ramblers, “Whitehouse Blues” (1926); (d) after Lomax and Lomax, “Stagolee” (1934, 94).

Metric positions: (8)

1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8

(a)

Phrase rhythm:
A

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

caesura

Dark
was
the
night,
cold
was
on
the
ground

B

5

6

7

8

The
last
word
I
heard
Frankie
say,
I
done
laid
old
Albert
down

R

9

10

11

12

He's
my
man,
and
he
done
me
wrong

(b)

A

1

2

3

4

caesura

Going
up
on
the
mountain,
take
my
stand

B

5

6

7

8

Forty-
one
derringer
in
my
right
and
left
hand

R

9

10

11

12

Now
I'm
gonna
ride
my
Rail-
road
Bill

(c)

A

1

2

3

4

caesura

Mc-
Kinley
hollered
Mc-
Kinley
squalled

B

5

6

7

8

Doc
says,
Mc-
Kinley
I
can't
find
that
ball

R

9

10

11

12

From
Buffa-
lo
to
Wash-
ing-
ton

(d)

A

1

2

3

4

caesura

'Twas
a
Christmas
morning,
the
hour
was
about
ten

B

5

6

7

8

When
Stag-
a-
lee
shot
Billy
Lyons
and
landed
in
the
Jeffer-
son
pen

R

9

10

11

12

O
lordy,
poor
Stag-
a-
lee

Example 2. Eight-bar blues with AB or ABR poetic form and 7,5 phase rhythm. (a) Bertha Chippie Hill, "Trouble in Mind" (1926); (b) Leroy Carr and Scrapper Blackwell, "How Long—How Long Blues" (1928); (c) Big Bill Broonzy, "Key to the Highway" (1941); (d) after Lomax and Lomax, "Stagolee" (1934, 96), third verse.

Metric positions: (8) 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

(a) **Phrase rhythm:** **A** 1 *caesura* 2 *caesura* 3 4

Trouble in mind, I'm blue, but I won't be al- **ways**

B 5 6 7 8

The sun's gonna shine in my back- ____ door some- **day**

(b) **A** 1 *caesura* 2 *caesura* **B** 3 4

How long, babe, how **long** Has that evening train been **gone?**

R 5 *caesura* 6 *caesura* 7 8

How long, how how long, baby, how long?

(c) **A** 1 *caesura* 2 *caesura* 3 4

I've got the key to the highway and I'm billed out ____ and bound to **go**

B 5 6 7 8

I'm gonna leave here running 'cause walking is most too **slow**

(d) **A** 1 *caesura* 2 *caesura* 3 4

It was early one morning when I heard my little dog **bark**

B 5 6 7 8

Stago- lee and Billy Lyon was argu- ing in the **dark**

Example 3. Two ballad schemes. (a) “Frankie and Johnny” scheme, Finious (Flat Foot) Rockwell, “Boll Weevil” (1940), second verse; (b) “Railroad Bill” scheme, Booker T. Sapps, “Frankie and Albert (Cooney and Delia)” (1935), lyrics partly based on Milling (1937, 4); (c) “Railroad Bill” scheme, Frank Hutchison, “Railroad Bill” (1929), second verse, wth substitution of III# in bars 5–6.

Metric positions: (8)

(a) **Phrase rhythm:**

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
A	[1]		[2]		[3]		[4]	
	The	farmer	take the boll	weevil,	laid	him down in	ice	
B	[5]		[6]		[7]		[8]	
	Boll weevil said to the	farm-	er,	"I'm	livin' me a hap-	py	life	
	IV		IV		IV			
R	[9]		[10]		[11]		[12]	
	This is my	home,		boll weevil's	home"			
	V		V					

(b)

A	[1]		[2]		[3]		[4]	
	Delia,		Delia,		why	didn't you	run	
B	[5]		[6]		[7]		[8]	
	When you	see that despa-	rado	had a	forty- four smokeless	gun?		
					IV		IV	
R	[9]		[10]		[11]		[12]	
	Crying	all I	had	done	gone			
			V					

(c)

A	[1]		[2]		[3]		[4]	
	Railroad		Bill		went out		west	
B	[5]		[6]		[7]		[8]	
	Shot all	the	buttons off a	break- man's		vest		
	III#		III#		IV		IV	
R	[9]		[10]		[11]		[12]	
	Well it's	get back	Railroad	Bill				
			V					

Example 4. Melodic designs of the "Frankie and Johnny" scheme. (a) "Frankie" tune with "Frankie" text, Gene Autry, "Frankie and Johnny" (1929), second verse; (b) "Frankie" tune with miscellaneous text, Frank Hutchison, "All Night Long" (1927); (c) idiosyncratic tune, Henry Thomas, "Bob McKinney" (1927), third verse.

(a) Autry

1 A emphasis on $\hat{5}$ upper neighbor to $\hat{5}$ descending arpeggiation of I caesura upper neighbor to $\hat{5}$ descending arpeggiation of I

Frank-ie went down_ to the cor-ner just for a buck-et of beer

5 B emphasis on $\hat{8}$ upper neighbor to $\hat{8}$ arpeggiation of IV descent to $\hat{5}$ R

She said, "Mis-ter bar-tend-er, has my lov-in John-ny been here? He is___ my man,

9 V V he would-n't do me wrong" I I

(b) Hutchison

1 A emphasis on $\hat{5}$ caesura upper neighbor to $\hat{5}$ descending arpeggiation of I B

My___ sweet-heart went a way last_night, that's why she's so un-kind Ev-

5 emphasis on $\hat{8}$ arpeggiation of IV upper neighbor to $\hat{8}$ descent to $\hat{5}$ R

-ery time___ she goes___ a-way___ she's al-ways on___ my mind All night

9 V V long, well it's all night___ long I I

(c) Thomas

1 A caesura

Bob-by said___ to Ben Ferris, "I'm bound to take___ your life

5 B caesura R

You cause___ trou-ble 'tween me___ and my wife" Was-n't he

9 V V bad Yes, was-n't he bad. I I

Example 5. Melodic design of the "Railroad Bill" scheme. (a) Will Bennett, "Railroad Bill" (1929); (b) Frank Hutchison, "Railroad Bill" (1929), second verse; (c) abstraction.

(a) Bennett

1 A prolongation of $\hat{3}$ caesura prolongation of $\hat{3}$

Rail - road Bill ought to be killed

1 I I I I

5 B prolongation of $\hat{3}$ descent to $\hat{1}$ R

Nev - er worked and he nev - er will Now I'm 'a ride

1 I I IV IV

9 $\hat{3}$ 10 11 $\hat{1}$ 12

my Rail - road Bill

I V I I

(b) Hutchison

1 A prolongation of $\hat{5}$ descent to $\hat{3}$

Rail - road Bill went out west

I I I I

5 B $\hat{3}$ $\hat{2}$ $\hat{1}$ $\hat{2}$ R

Shot all the but - tons off a break - man's vest Well it's

III# III# IV IV

9 $\hat{3}$ 10 $\hat{2}$ 11 $\hat{1}$ 12

get back Rail - road Bill

I V I I

(c) Abstraction

1 2 3 4

I I I I

5 6 7 8

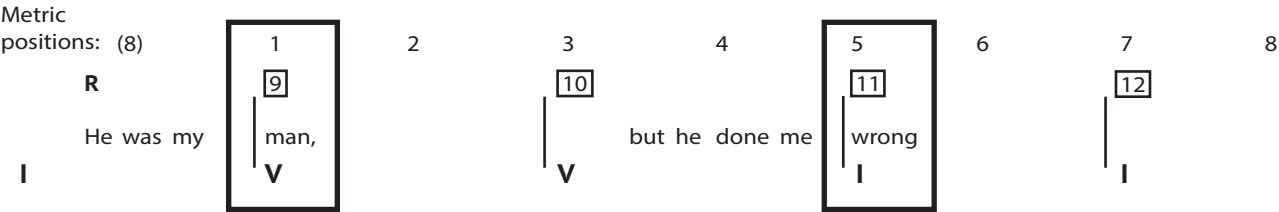
I III# I III# IV IV

9 10 11 12

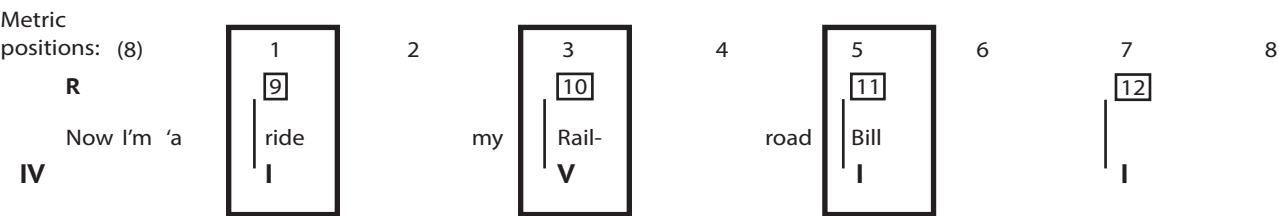
I V I I

Example 6. Downbeat accents and harmonic rhythm in the refrains of ballad schemes. (a) Two downbeat accents match two harmonic shifts in the “Frankie and Johnny” refrain; (b) three downbeat accents match three harmonic shifts in the “Railroad Bill” refrain.

(a) “Frankie and Johnny” refrain



(b) “Railroad Bill” refrain



Example 7. Eight-bar blues schemes. (a) “Trouble in Mind” scheme, Cliff Carlisle, “Trouble Minded Blues” (1937); (b) “Key to the Highway” scheme, Charley Patton, “Jim Lee Blues—Part I” (1929); (c) “How Long” scheme, Blind Willie McTell and Ruby Glaze, “Lonesome Day Blues” (1932).

Metric positions: (8)

(a) **Phrase rhythm:**

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
A	[1]	<i>caesura</i>	[2]	<i>caesura</i>	[3]		[4]	
Trouble,	trouble,	I’m	blue,	some-	body	com-	fort	me
	I		V		I			IV
B	[5]		[6]		[7]		[8]	
Oh, I’m	leavin’	here	lone-ly	as	can			be
	I		V		I			I
								V
								<i>turnaround</i>

(b)

A	[1]	<i>caesura</i>	[2]	<i>caesura</i>	[3]		[4]	
I went a-	way	up the	river	some	for-	ty	miles	or
	I		V		IV			IV
B	[5]		[6]		[7]		[8]	
I	think I	heard that	big	Jim	Lee			blow
	I		V		I			I

(c)

A	[1]	<i>caesura</i>	[2]	<i>caesura</i>	B	[3]		[4]
You can	go,	you can	stay	But you’ll	home	some old lone-	some	day
	I		I	come	IV			IV
R	[5]		[6]		[7]		[8]	
I’m coming	home to my baby	some old lone-	some	day				I
	I		V		I			I

Example 8. "How Long" scheme, harmonic progressions and melodic designs. (a) Leroy Carr and Scrapper Blackwell, "How Long—How Long Blues" (1928); (b) Blind Willie McTell and Ruby Glaze, "Lonesome Day Blues" (1932); (c) Peg Leg Howell, "Rolling Mill Blues" (1929), eighth verse.

Metric positions: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

(a) Carr

How long, babe, how long Has, that eve - ning train been gone? How long

How, how long, ba - by, how long?

(b) Glaze

You can go, you can stay But you'll come home some old lone - some day I'm comin' home

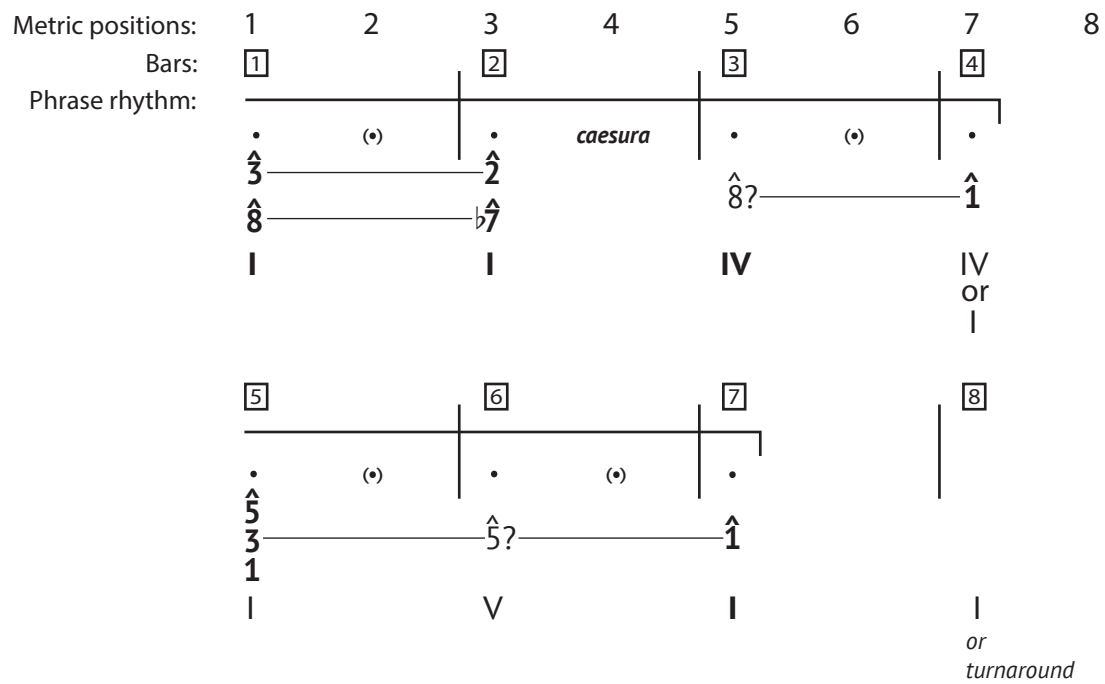
to my ba - by some old lone - some day

(c) Howell

Was late last night When my hon - ny come home I heard a

rap - pin' on her door

Example 9. Graphic illustration of the “How Long” scheme.



Example 10. "Stackolee" text with "Frankie" scheme. (a) Ma Rainey, "Stack O'Lee Blues" (1925), with "Frankie" tune; (b) Woody Guthrie, "Stackolee" (1944), second verse, with idiosyncratic melody.

(a) Rainey

upper neighbor to $\hat{5}$
arpeggiation of I

2 *caesura* 3 upper neighbor to $\hat{5}$
arpeggiation of I

4 **B**

Stack O'Lee was a bad man, ev-ery bod - y knowed And

5 emphasis on $\hat{8}$
arpeggiation of IV

6 *caesura* 7 descent to $\hat{5}$ 8 **R**

when they see Stack O' - Lee com - in' they give him the road He was my man,

9 **V** 10 **V** 11 **I** 12 **I**

but he done me wrong

(b) Guthrie

1 **A** 2 *caesura* 3 4

Stack - o - lee load - ed cot - ton, weighed five hun - dred pounds

5 **B** 6 **IV** 7 **IV** 8 **R**

Car - ried a - long in a gat - ling gun and drug him to the ground He was a

9 **V** 10 **V** 11 **V** 12 **V** 13 **I** 14 **I** 15 **I** 16 **I**

bad man, that mean old Stack - o - lee

Example 11. "Stackolee" text with "Railroad Bill" scheme. (a) Furry Lewis, "Billy Lyons and Stack O'Lee" (1927), with "Railroad Bill" tune diatonic harmony; (b) Long "Cleve" Reed and Little Harvey Hull, "Original Stack O'Lee Blues" (1927), with "Railroad Bill" tune and chromatic substitution.

(a) Lewis

A prolongation of $\hat{3}$ *caesura* 3 4

I re - mem-ber one Sep - tem - ber, on one Fri - day night

B prolongation of $\hat{3}$ 5 6 7 descent to $\hat{1}$ 2 8 **R**

Stack O' - Lee and Bil - ly Ly - ons had a great fight Cry - in' when you

9 10 11 12

lose your mon - ey Ly - ons you lose

(b) Hull

A prolongation of $\hat{3}$ *caesura* 3 4 **B**

Stack O'Lee was a bul - ly, he bul - lied all his life Well he bul -

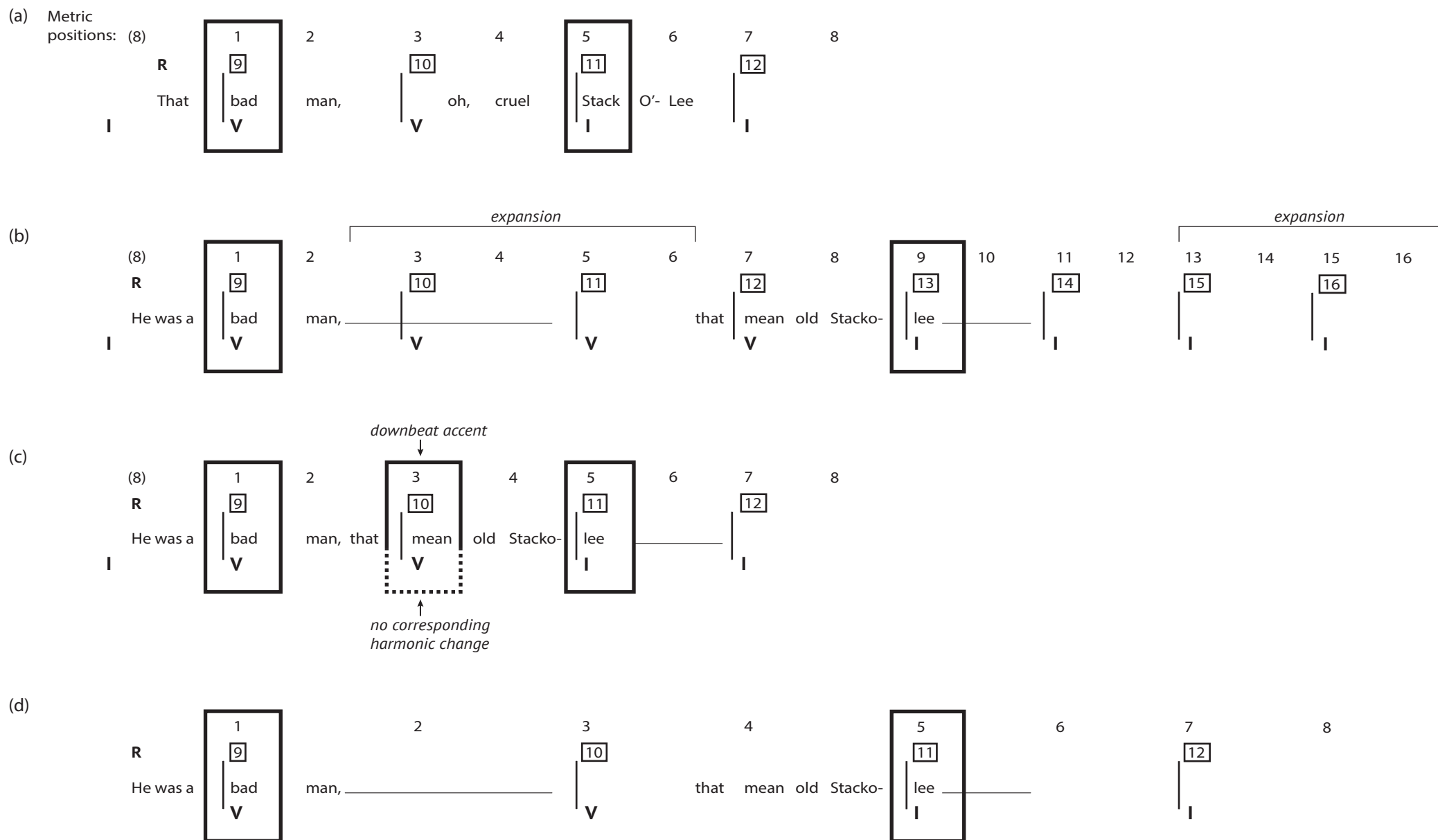
5 6 7 descent to $\hat{1}$ 8 **R**

- lied to Chi - ca - go town with a ten - cent pock-et knife And it's

9 10 11 12

oh Stack O' - Lee

Example 12. Two-accent refrain of the “Frankie and Johnny” scheme with two-accent “Stackolee” refrains. (a) Mississippi John Hurt, “Stack O’Lee Blues” (1928); (b) Woody Guthrie, “Stackolee” (1944), with expansion and extension of the refrain; (c) hypothetical version of Guthrie’s refrain without the expansions; (d) Guthrie’s refrain interpreted on a higher hypermetric level.



Example 13. Three-accent refrain of the “Railroad Bill” scheme with three-accent “Stackolee” refrains. (a) Furry Lewis, “Billy Lyons and Stackolee” (1927); (b) Long “Cleve” Reed and Little Harvey Hull, “Original Stack O’Lee Blues” (1927).

(a)

Metric
positions: (8)

1

9

lose

I

2

3

10

money,

V

4

5

11

lose

I

6

7

12

I

8

Cryin' when you

your

Lyons, you

R

IV

(b)

1

9

oh

I

2

3

10

Stack

V

4

5

11

Lee

I

6

7

12

I

8

And it's

O'-

R

IV

Example 14. "Stackolee" text with "How Long" scheme. (a) Lucious Curtis and Willie Ford, "Stagolee" (1940); (b) after Lomax and Lomax, "Stagolee," Version B (1934, 96); (c) Archibald, "Stack A'lee (Parts I and II)" (1950), second verse; (d) Wilson Pickett, "Stagger Lee" (1968).

accented positions

Metric positions: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

(a) Curtis

A 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 B

It was late last night, I heard my bull-dog bark Stag-o-lee

and Bill-y Lyons they was arg-guing in the dark

(b) Lomax

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 B

Stag-o-lee, he was a bad man, and eve-ry bo-dy knows He

tot-ed a stack barreled blow-gun and a blue steel forty-four

(c) Archibald

A 1 2 3 4 B

It was Stack A'-Lee and Bill-y two men who gam-bled late Stack A'-Lee

threwed sev-en Bill-y swore that he threwed eight

(d) Pickett

A 1 2 3 4 B

I was stand-in' on the cor-ner when I heard my bull-dog bark He was bark-

in' at two men who was gamb-lin' in the dark

The image displays four musical staves, each representing a different version of the song 'Stackolee'. Each staff is labeled with a letter (a, b, c, d) and a name. The notation includes treble clefs, key signatures (one sharp for a, b, and d; one flat for c), and time signatures (8/8 for a, b, and d; 12/8 for c). Above each staff, metric positions (1-8) and accented positions (indicated by a hat symbol ^) are marked. The lyrics are written below the notes, with some words underlined. Roman numerals (I, IV, V, VI, VII) are placed below the lyrics to indicate harmonic structure. The word 'caesura' is written above the staff in several places. The staves are arranged vertically, with (a) at the top and (d) at the bottom.